

Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021: Grievance Appellate Committees Transparency Report in accordance with Rule 3A(7)

In accordance with Rule 3A(7) of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021 ("IT Rules"), Google is publishing this report with details of orders received by Google from the Grievance Appellate Committees.

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Appeals by Google service and outcome

This report outlines the number of user appeals received by Google from the Grievance Appellate Committees (GAC) during the period April 1, 2024 to September 30, 2024, the Google service associated with each appeal and the outcome of each appeal to the extent decided.

Upon receipt of an appeal from a user aggrieved by an order passed under Google's Grievance Redressal processes, the GAC either admits the appeal and subsequently reviews Google's decision on the initial complaint made to the Grievance Redressal mechanisms or the GAC declines to admit the appeal. The GAC may decline to admit the appeal, for instance, in cases where the appellant did not file an initial complaint as per the Grievance Redressal processes or where the appeal was filed for an action taken by the platforms on the basis of court order or appropriate government requests. If the appeal is admitted, the GAC upholds or overturns the original decision taken by Google's Grievance Redressal mechanisms and issues an order.

During the reporting period, the GAC closed 27 appeals relating to Google services (see breakdown of appeals, by service and outcome, in the table below). The GAC upheld Google's original decision for five of these appeals, rejecting the appeals. 17 appeals were not admitted by the GAC and therefore no action was required by Google. The GAC allowed five appeals during this period. Google has complied with the GAC's directions in three of the appeals¹ and sought review of the GAC's order in one of the appeals². Google has informed the GAC that no further action is required on the remaining one appeal.

Service	Appeals Closed	Appeals Rejected	Appeals Allowed	Appeals Not Admitted
YouTube	11	1	4	6
Gmail	11	3	1	7
Google Search	3	1	0	2
Google Play	1	0	0	1
Google Ads	1	0	0	1
Total	27 ³	5	5	17

¹ Google diligently complied with the orders, while also proactively communicating concerns to the GAC regarding the prescribed routes for specific subject matters. Google emphasized the importance of adhering to established legal channels and procedures available under existing laws.

² In this instance, the GAC's directions could not be complied with whilst also preserving Google's position as an intermediary under Indian law.

³ This does not include the appeals that have been received but are pending a final decision by the GAC.